

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	Ten Obligatory Acts of Shi'a Islam: their nature, history and purpose of the Ten Obligatory Acts; the diversity of practice and importance of Ten Obligatory Acts for Shi'a Muslims today; their basis in the Qur'an, including reference to Surah 9:71-73; divergent understandings of these principles within Sunni Islam, including links with the Five Pillars.
3.2	Shahadah as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role and significance of Shahadah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including reference to Surah 3:17-21; why reciting Shahadah is important for Muslims, and its place in Muslim practice today.
3.3*	Salah as one of the Five Pillars, including reference to Surah 15:98-99 and 29:45: the nature, history, significance and purpose of Salah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including different ways of understanding them; how Salah is performed, including ablution, times, directions, movements and recitations, in the home and mosque and Jumma prayer.
3.4	Sawm as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, significance and purpose of fasting during Ramadan, including Surah 2:183-185; those who are excused from fasting and why. The significance of the Night of Power: the nature, history and purpose of the Night of Power; why Laylat al-Qadr is important for Muslims today.
3.5	Zakah as one of the Five Pillars and Khums: the nature, role, significance and purpose of Zakah and Khums, including Surah 9:58-60 and 8:36-42; why Zakah is important for Sunni Muslims; why Khums is important for Shi'a Muslims; the benefits of receiving Zakah or Khums.
3.6	Hajj as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, origins and significance of Hajj, including Surah 2:124-130 and 22:25-30; how Hajj is performed and why Hajj is important for Muslims; benefits and challenges of performing Hajj for Muslims.
3.7	Jihad: the origins, meaning and significance of Jihad in Islam; divergent understandings of Jihad within Islam, including the difference between lesser and greater Jihad; the conditions for declaration of lesser Jihad, including reference to Surah 2:190-194 and 22:39; the importance of Jihad in the life of Muslims.
3.8	The nature, origins, activities, meaning and significance of the celebration/commemoration of Id-ul-Adha, with reference to Surah 37:77-111, and Id-ul-Fitr in Sunni Islam, with reference to their place within Shi'a Islam; and Id-ul-Ghadeer, with reference to Hadith and the interpretation of Surah 5:3, and Ashura in Shi'a Islam, with reference to their place within Sunni Islam.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Muslim teachings about origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Muslim responses to them, including Surah 67:1–5, and the compatibility of the Qur'an and science; divergent Muslim teachings about the value of the universe in Islam and the possible view that the universe is to be used as a commodity.
4.2	Muslim teachings about the sanctity of life: Muslim teachings about why human life is holy; how life is shown as special in the Qur'an, including Surah 5:32 and 4:29; Muslim teachings on the sanctity of life; divergent understandings of the importance of sanctity of life for Muslims today.
4.3	Muslim responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins and value of human life, including evolution and survival of the fittest, including interpretations of Surah 32:4–10 and 21:30–33; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Muslims today.
4.4	Implications of the Muslim teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: divergent Muslim teachings about the nature and use of abortion, including reference to ensoulment and Sahih al-Bukhari 55:549; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them.
4.5	Muslim responses to the existence of death and the afterlife: Muslim teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death with reference to the Qur'an, including Surah 28:60–80; divergent Muslim responses to arguments for life after death (including remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones); the significance of arguments for belief in life after death for Muslims.
4.6	Muslim responses to non-religious arguments against life after death, including Surah 45:22–37: why Muslims reject arguments against belief in life after death, including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control.
4.7	Implications of Muslim teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: Muslim teachings about the nature and use of euthanasia; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use; the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them, including Surah 2:153–156 and support for hospice care.
4.8	Muslim responses to issues in the natural world: Muslim teachings and responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources, stewardship and humanity's role as khalifah; divergent Muslim responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, including Sahih al-Bukhari 45:656 and the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.

Area of Study 1D – Buddhism

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Buddhism as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life, specifically within families, and with regard to matters of life and death.

There are four sections: Buddhist Beliefs, Marriage and the Family, Living the Buddhist Life and Matters of Life and Death.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Buddhists today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how scripture informs a Buddhist's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Buddhism within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Buddhism with Christianity as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.5)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.6)*

Students should recognise that Buddhism is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Hinduism, Judaism, Islam, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Buddhism and non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Buddhism there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Buddhism in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Theravada and Mahayana traditions.